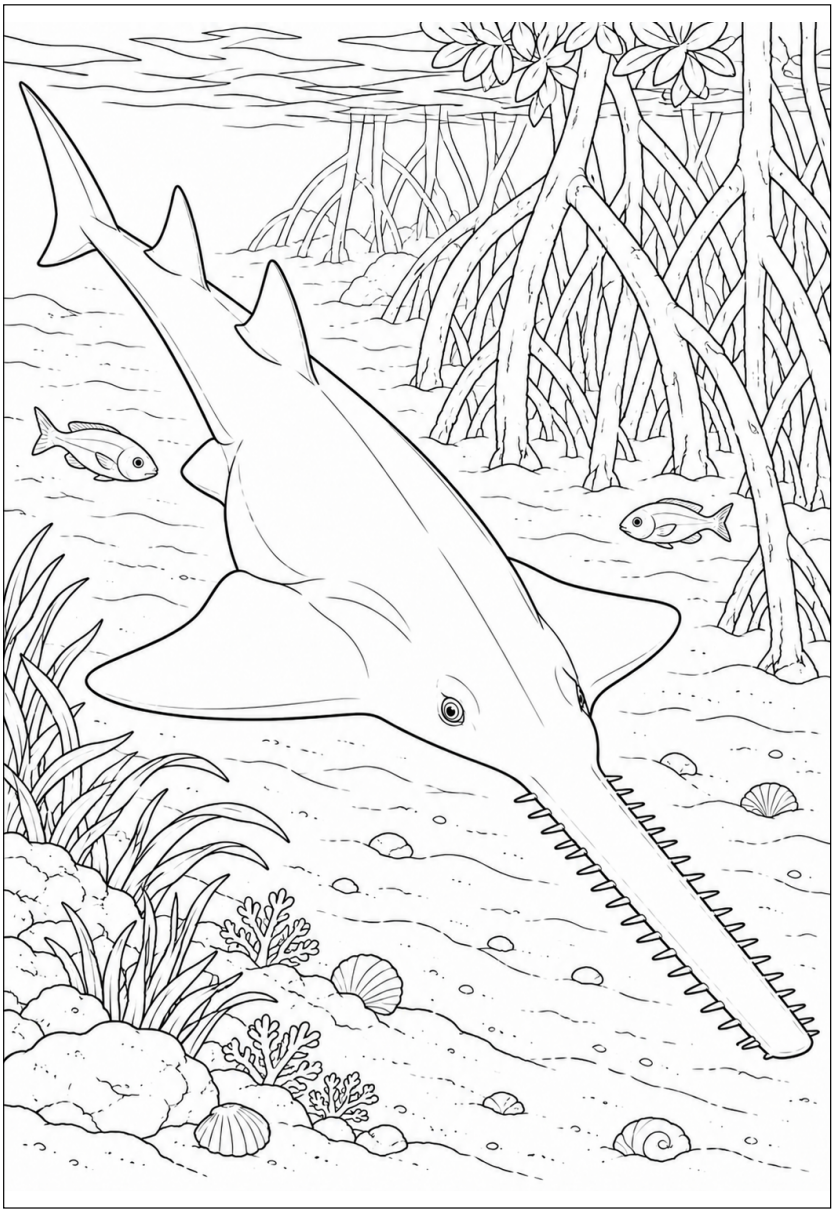
Smalltooth Sawfish

Pristis pectinata

More info



Where does it live?



Dots: land White: sea

Examples: Florida and the Bahamas

ITS HOME

Warm Atlantic coastal waters. Pups live in shallows and river mouths.

HOW IS IT BORN?

It gives birth to live pups. They find their own food from birth.

WHAT DOES IT EAT?

Mostly fish, and sometimes shrimp.

IT IS A RAY

Its mouth and gill slits are on the underside of its body.

A SENSING SAW

Its saw detects weak electrical fields from prey and helps catch it.

SIZE AND GROWTH

An adult sawfish can reach about 5 metres, including its saw. A newborn pup is about 70 centimetres long. It can double its length during its first year.

WHY IT NEEDS PROTECTION

The smalltooth sawfish is Critically Endangered worldwide. Fishing nets can trap it, and coastal places where its pups grow are disappearing.